LESSON 00 · MISSION GUIDE

The Keeper's Oath

Set up your desk, meet the court, and fix your first page of Dalvric's code.

From **Queen Aldara of Thornmere**
To **Jen, Keeper of the Ledger**
By raven **A royal welcome (and a small favour)**

Jen, welcome to the Royal Treasury of Thornmere! Counting the realm's coin since the year 1019.

A small confession. Every wage in the realm is reckoned by the **Grimoire of Dalvric**, about 4,000 lines of incantations left by a court wizard who sailed west and never came back. It fails every full moon. Nobody dares touch it. We have signed the Accord of Equal Coin, the pay gap report is due at Midsummer, and everyone keeps telling me "Python" is the answer.

We do not know what a Python is, but we have approved the budget (it is free, which we like). Today: get your computer set up and say hello. Tea is in the kitchens. Do not let Biscuit near the abacus. — A.

Meet the court

Queen Aldara. Sends decrees at dusk on the last day of the week. "No pressure. (Some pressure.)"

Orrin of the Clockworks. Keeps the realm's machines running. Has seen things.

Dalvric the Vanished, court wizard, sailed west in 1019. His torn pages turn up in every lesson, always broken.

Mistress Pell, Paymaster of the Guilds. Sharp, busy, and the source of most of your ravens.

Lady Siv of the Rewards. Needs yes or no, never "mayhap".

Biscuit, a small kitchen dragon. Not allowed near the abacus. Often near the abacus.

What you'll be able to do after today

- [ ] Install Python, VS Code and Git on your own computer
- [ ] Run Python three ways: the interactive prompt, a script, and the ▶ button
- [ ] Explain **repository, commit, branch** and **pull request** in your own words
- [ ] Write a small script, run it, and check it against the expected output
- [ ] Read an error message and find **which line** is broken and **what kind** of problem it is

Why this matters at work

- **VBA lives inside a workbook. Python lives outside.** A Python script can open 300 wage scrolls overnight without anyone clicking "Enable macros".
- **Git is Track Changes for code**, with a full audit trail: who changed what, when, and why. The Royal Auditors like audit trails.
- **A script does the same thing every time**, unlike copy-paste at dusk on the last day of the week.

How today works

BEFORE	15 MIN	45 MIN	15 MIN
Setup	**Lecture**	**Exercise sheet**	**Grimoire, page 0**
Follow `SETUP.md`, 30–45 min	Lars shows how it all fits together	Write it all yourself, on your own	Fix Dalvric's welcome script

Your three documents

GUIDE.pdf	This one. What's going on and why.
EXERCISES.pdf	The exercise sheet. Five exercises; you write every file yourself in `my_work/`.
CHEATSHEET.pdf	One page of commands. Keep it open while you work.

How to check your work

There's no marking robot. Every exercise shows the **expected output**. Run your file and compare: same output means done. If you get an error instead, read it like this:

```
PS> python my_work/hello.py
  File "my_work/hello.py", line 2                    ← WHERE: file and line
    print("A salary of 32,500 crowns a year is", 32500 / 12, "a month"
          ^
SyntaxError: '(' was never closed                    ← WHAT went wrong
```

Read the **last line** first (what went wrong), then go to the **line number** (where). An error message isn't a telling-off. It's Python pointing at the problem for you.

You're done when...

- [ ] `my_work/` contains `hello.py` and `about_me.py`, and both print the expected output
- [ ] Dalvric's page runs and prints the three expected lines
- [ ] Everything is pushed to `lesson-00` and you've opened a pull request



Next lesson: Mistress Pell's Ravens. Seven ravens, one failed Grimoire, and the Queen wants the pay gap "in a sentence". You'll learn how Python handles numbers, text and formatting, the bread and butter of every treasury.